

Xi Yang

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University of North Texas

Department of Economics

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Research

Fields: Housing and Urban Economics; Labor Economics; Household Finance

Methods: Quasi-Experimental Policy Evaluation; Restricted-Access Census Microdata; Large-Scale Text and Administrative Data

Education

2008–2014 Ph.D. Economics, Johns Hopkins University

Advisor: Robert A. Moffitt

Dissertation: "Essays on the Labor Market, Housing, and Children's Outcomes"

2005–2008 M.A. Economics, China Center for Economic Research (CCER), Peking University

2001–2005 B.A. Economics and Mathematics, Wuhan University

Academic Appointments

2023–present Associate Professor, *Department of Economics, University of North Texas*

2026–present Affiliate Faculty, *Anuradha and Vikas Sinha Department of Data Science, University of North Texas*

2021–present Special Sworn Status Researcher, *U.S. Census Bureau*

2016–2023 Assistant Professor, *Department of Economics, University of North Texas*

2014–2016 Post-Doctoral Research Fellow, *Lusk Center for Real Estate, Sol Price School of Public Policy, University of Southern California*

Visiting Positions

2024 Fall Visiting Scholar, *Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (IRLE), University of California, Berkeley*

2023 August Visiting Scholar, *MIT Center for Real Estate*

Policy Engagement

2024–present Academic Committee Member, *Housing Finance Policy Center, Urban Institute*

2023–2024 Research Advisor, *Texas Zoning Atlas, a collaborative of the National Zoning Atlas*

2019–2020 Fellow, *Lincoln Institute of Land Policy Scholars Program*

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. "Does Rent Regulation Affect Tenant Unemployment? Evidence from New York City," with Hanchen Jiang and Luis Quintero. *Journal of Urban Economics*, 149, 2025.

2. "Housing Wealth as Precautionary Savings: Evidence from Urban China," with Gary Painter and Ninghua Zhong. *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*, 57(2), 761–789, 2022.
3. "Human Capital Externalities or Consumption Spillovers? The Effect of High-Skill Human Capital across Low-Skill Labor Markets," with Shimeng Liu. *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, 87, 2021.
4. "Land Use Regulations and Urban Growth of African Americans." *Economic Development Quarterly*, 35(4), 338–350, 2021.
5. "Impact of Land Use Regulation across the Conditional Distribution of Home Prices: An Application of Quantile Regression for Group-Level Treatments," with Tammy Leonard and Lei Zhang. *Annals of Regional Science*, 66, 655–676, 2021.
6. "Property Tax Limits and Female Labor Supply: Evidence from the Housing Boom and Bust," with Shimeng Liu. *Journal of Housing Economics*, 50, 2020.
7. "Housing Demand and Household Saving in China: Evidence from a Housing Reform," with Binkai Chen and Ninghua Zhong. *Journal of Housing Economics*, 49, 2020.
8. "Impact of Property Tax Abatement Incentives on Economic Growth," with Tammy Leonard, Lei Zhang, and Connor Reed. *Economic Development Quarterly*, 34(2), 209–221, 2020.
9. "The Effect of Home Ownership on Post-Unemployment Wages." *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, 74, 1–17, 2019. (lead article)
10. "Market Facilitation by Local Government and Firm Efficiency: Evidence from China," with Robert Cull, Lixin Colin Xu, Li-An Zhou, and Tian Zhu. *Journal of Corporate Finance*, 42, 460–480, 2017.
11. "Environmental Compliance and Firm Performance: Evidence from China," with Yang Yao. *Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics*, 74(3), 397–424, 2012.

Working Papers

Revise and Resubmit

1. "More Credit, More Babies? Bank Credit Expansion, Housing Prices, and Fertility." *Revise and resubmit, Journal of Urban Economics*.
2. "The Finance-Education Nexus: Educational Consequences of U.S. Interstate Bank Branching Deregulation," with Jian Zou. *Revise and resubmit, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*.
3. "Fertility Rates for Renters Have Fallen More than for Owners: What Explains the Divergence?" with Jung Hyun Choi (Urban Institute). *Revise and resubmit, Housing Studies*.

Working Papers

1. "Housing Wealth and Female Labor Supply: Evidence from Geographically Linked Microdata." (U.S. Census Research Data Center project; under review)
2. "Housing Wealth, Liquidity, and Retirement Timing: Evidence from Linked Administrative Data." (U.S. Census Research Data Center project)
3. "Housing Wealth and Intergenerational Investment: Evidence on College Enrollment from Linked Administrative Data." (U.S. Census Research Data Center project)
4. "Land Use Regulation, Housing Costs, and Childcare Costs," with Chang Jae (CJ) Lee.
5. "Property Division Law and Fertility: Evidence from China," with Ang Sun, Emma Zang (Sociology), and Zitong Wang. *Under review*.
6. "SNAP, SSI, and the Economic Security of Older Adults," with Robert A. Moffitt.

Invited Chapters

1. “Causal Analysis of Child-Care Policies,” with Hanchen Jiang and Chang Jae (CJ) Lee. Invited chapter, *Handbook of Labor, Human Resources, and Population Economics*.

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

External Funding and Awards

2026	Peer-to-Peer Mentoring Program Grant, Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP) (\$1,000), with Leah Lakdawala, Shooshan Danagoulain, and Amanda Gaulke
2025–2027	Institute for Humane Studies (\$5,000), with Yang Zhou
2025–2026	Early Career Research Award, W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research (\$7,000), with Hanchen Jiang
2024–2025	Retirement and Disability Research Center (RDRC) Grant, Social Security Administration, via University of Wisconsin–Madison (\$127,950), with Robert A. Moffitt
2023–2024	NBER–NSF Mentorship Program (course release)
2021	Scholar, Proposal Development Summer Institute, Russell Sage Foundation
2019	Homer Hoyt Institute Best Paper Award, Asian Real Estate Society

Internal Funding, University of North Texas

2024–2025	Individual Mentoring Grant (\$1,500)
2023–2024	Research Seed Funding (\$10,000), with Lauren Fischer (Urban Planning) and Yang Zhou
2022–2023	Scholarly and Creativity Award (\$4,000)
2022	Creative and Research Enhancement for Engagement (CREATE) Program (\$5,000)
2021–2022	Team Mentoring Grant, member (\$5,000)

Presentations

Invited Seminars

2026	Virtual Economics of Poverty and Policy Seminar University of Auckland (Property Seminar) Dallas Applied Micro Accelerator Group Seminar Seoul National University, “Housing Affordability and Demographic Dynamics” Workshop (two papers)
2025	Urban Institute, Housing Finance Policy Center University of North Texas, Data Science Talk Series
2024	University of California, Berkeley, Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (IRLE) Seminar University of California, Berkeley, Labor Lunch Seminar University of Arkansas Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas (Research Brownbag) Tongji University
2023	Johns Hopkins University, Carey Business School Southern Methodist University

- Texas Christian University
- University of Southern California, Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Seminar
- University of North Texas, Department of Economics
- American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) Virtual Seminar
- 2022 Texas A&M University
- University of North Texas, Department of Economics
- 2021 Shanghai University of Finance and Economics
- 2020 Jinan University
- University of North Texas, Department of Economics
- 2016–2019 Chinese University of Hong Kong
- Tongji University
- Central University of Finance and Economics
- Texas A&M University
- University of Southern California, Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Seminar
- University of North Texas (Economics; Public Administration; G. Brint Ryan College of Business)

Conference Presentations (including scheduled)

- 2026 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting
- Society of Government Economists (SGE) sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting
- Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting
- Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting
- North Texas Economics Conference, Texas Christian University
- 2025 AREUEA National Conference
- Federal Statistical Research Data Center (FSRDC) Annual Research Conference, Cornell University
- Urban Economics Association (UEA) North American Meeting
- North Texas Economics Conference, University of Texas at Arlington
- 2024 Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting
- Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference
- Housing Workshop, Consumer Finance Institute (Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) and Fannie Mae
- North Texas Economics Conference, University of North Texas
- 2023 AREUEA sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting
- NBER Conference on Fertility
- MIT Asia Real Estate Symposium
- U.S. Census Bureau SIPP Virtual Conference
- 2022 Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting
- Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting
- Urban Economics Association (UEA) North American Meeting
- 2021 AREUEA sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting
- Jinan–SMU–ABFER Conference on Urban and Regional Economics

- 2020 AREUEA National Conference
Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Conference
W.E. Upjohn Institute Researcher Workshop
- 2019 AREUEA National Conference
Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Conference
Biennial Conference on China Development Studies
- 2018 W.E. Upjohn Institute Researcher Workshop
- 2017 AREUEA sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting
Chinese Economists Society (CES) North America Conference
- 2015 AREUEA National Conference
Urban Economics Association (UEA) Annual Meeting
Annual Urban Research Day Symposium, University of California, Irvine

Discussant and Session Chair

Chinese Economists Society sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting (2026); AREUEA sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting (2023, 2025); AREUEA National Conference (2024, 2025); Transportation and Public Utilities Group (TPUG) sessions, ASSA Annual Meeting (2024); Economic Demography Workshop (2024); North Texas Economics Conference (2024, 2025); Urban Economics Association Annual Meeting (2022)

Professional Service

Editorial and Refereeing

Editorial Board: *International Studies of Economics* (2025–present)

Referee: *Journal of Urban Economics*; *Journal of Human Resources*; *Demography*; *Housing Policy Debate*; *Journal of Housing Economics* ($\times 3$); *Journal of Real Estate Finance and Economics*; *Journal of Urban Affairs*; *Regional Science and Urban Economics* ($\times 3$); *Journal of Regional Science* ($\times 6$); *China Economic Review* ($\times 6$); *Economic Development Quarterly* ($\times 2$); *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization* ($\times 2$); *Southern Economic Journal*; *Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics*, among others

Profession

- 2026 Mentor, CSWEP Junior Mentoring Breakfast, AEA Annual Meeting
- 2024–2025 Member, Membership Committee, AREUEA
- 2024–2025 Board Member, Chinese Economists Society
- 2024–2025 Program Organizer, CES sessions at the 2026 ASSA Meeting, and the CES 2025 North America Conference
- 2024–2025 Mentor, Chinese Economists Society Mentorship Workshop
- 2023–2025 Member, Women in Real Estate Network Committee, AREUEA

University of North Texas

2026–2027	Member, Tenure and Promotion Committee
2026–2027	Member, Department Faculty Search Committee
2025–2026	Search for Research, Texas Academy of Mathematics and Science
2023–2024	Member, Political Science Department Faculty Search Committee
2022–2023	Member, Department Lecturer Search Committee
2021–2023	Member, UNT ASPIRE IChange Network Team
2020–present	Member, Department Personnel Affairs Committee
2019–present	Member, Department Academic Integrity Appeals Committee
2019–2020	Member, Department Faculty Search Committee

Affiliations: American Economic Association (AEA); Society of Labor Economists (SOLE); American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA); Urban Economics Association (UEA); Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM); Chinese Economists Society (CES)

Teaching and Advising

*Courses**University of North Texas*

2025–present	Economics of Inequality and Discrimination (ECON 3150, UG)
2023–present	Advanced Microeconomics (ECON 5340, graduate)
2016–present	Labor Economics (ECON 4290, UG/graduate)
2016–present	Intermediate Microeconomics (ECON 3550, UG)
2022	Honors College Mentored Research Experience (ECON 3996, UG)

Tongji University and University of Southern California

2018–2023	Housing and Urban Economics, Tongji University (invited summer course)
2015	Economics for Policy, Planning, and Development (MPP 501, graduate), USC

Advising

Graduate research assistants and advisees (placement): Sakir Inteser (Texas A&M University); Letitia Wangoya (UC Merced, Economics Ph.D.); Abiokpoyanam P. Batubo (Virginia Tech, Agricultural Economics Ph.D.); Reza Gharoie (UNT, Finance Ph.D.); Rumian Reza (Vanderbilt University, Economics Ph.D.); Umesh Jaiswal (UNT, Finance Ph.D.); Himani Sharma (UC Irvine, Economics Ph.D.); Abir Arabi (Washington University in St. Louis, Economics Ph.D.)

Undergraduate honors theses: Kevin Guima (Fall 2022); Ananya Sayyaparaju (Fall 2022); Mitchell Dudek (Fall 2025)